

SALON & SPA MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Project Plan & Delivery Case Study

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PROJECT OVERVIEW

Salon & Spa CRM, Full-Stack SaaS Product

Led the full lifecycle delivery of a Salon & Spa CRM platform, from initial discovery and product scoping through architecture, phased development, quality assurance, and deployment readiness. The project was structured across 10 clearly defined phases with individual checklists, deliverables, and acceptance criteria, completed within a 5-week sprint-based schedule.

This case study documents the project management approach, planning methodology, stakeholder decisions, risk management, and delivery outcomes, demonstrating end-to-end ownership of a complex, multi-module software product.

PROJECT

Salon & Spa CRM Platform

ROLE

Technical Lead / Project Manager

DURATION

5 Weeks (Sprint-Based)

METHODOLOGY

Phased Agile / Feature-Driven

TEAM SIZE

Cross-functional (Design, Dev, QA)

THE PROBLEM

Salon and spa businesses are forced into expensive third-party SaaS platforms with per-user pricing, per-module add-ons, and recurring monthly fees that scale with team size. Client data is stored on external servers with no ownership, and growing teams face escalating costs just to unlock basic features like reporting, staff management, or billing, creating a long-term financial burden for small and medium businesses.

THE SOLUTION

A self-hosted Salon & Spa Management System that eliminates recurring subscription costs entirely. Deployed on the business's own server, giving full ownership of client data with no external dependencies. Unlimited users, all modules included, no per-seat fees, a single deployment that grows with the business without any additional cost.

PROJECT SCOPE & OBJECTIVES

Primary Objective

Deliver a fully functional, production-ready Salon & Spa management platform covering bookings, billing, staff, clients, and analytics.

Scope Definition

Defined 12 core modules across 10 delivery phases. Each phase had explicit entry/exit criteria, a feature checklist, and a git commit milestone.

Constraints

Zero external budget. Required clean, maintainable codebase. All third-party dependencies must be open-source or free-tier.

Success Criteria

All roles functional end-to-end. No critical bugs on submission. PDF generation, digital signatures, and real-time booking engine fully operational

TECHNOLOGY STACK

Backend

Laravel 11, PHP 8.4, Spatie Permission, DomPDF

Auth

Laravel Breeze, Role Middleware,
Module Access Control

Frontend

Frontend Blade Templates, Alpine.js,
Tailwind CSS v3

Booking

Booking Custom BookingEngine Service,
Resource Conflict Detection

Database

Database MySQL 8, Eloquent ORM,
Database Queues

Dev

Dev Tools Laravel Telescope, Git,
Laragon, VS Code, Jira

5-WEEK DELIVERY TIMELINE

Week 1

Phase 1

- ✓ Project Setup
- ✓ Auth, Role System
- ✓ Base Layout

Phase 2

- ✓ Staff Management
- ✓ Working Hours
- ✓ Access Permissions

Phase 3

- ✓ Management Records
- ✓ Loyalty
- ✓ Medical Notes

Week 2

Phase 4

- ✓ Services
- ✓ Categories
- ✓ Resources & Conflict Model

Phase 5

- ✓ Booking Engine
- ✓ Slot Logic
- ✓ Calendar
- ✓ Waitlist

Week 3

Phase 6

- ✓ Billing & Invoicing
- ✓ Payments
- ✓ PDF Export

Phase 7

- ✓ Digital Intake Forms
- ✓ Consultation Notes

Week 4

Phase 8

- ✓ Reports & Analytics
- ✓ Revenue
- ✓ Staff Performance
- ✓ Clients

Phase 9

- ✓ Settings
- ✓ Branding & Access
- ✓ Control Panel

Week 5

QA End-to-end
testing across all 5
user roles

Phase 10

- ✓ Final Polish
- ✓ Error Pages
- ✓ Demo Data
- ✓ Documentation

STAKEHOLDER MANAGEMENT & DECISION LOG

DECISION	Details	STATUS
Self-Hosted Architecture	Evaluated cloud SaaS vs self-hosted deployment. Chose self-hosted to reduce infrastructure cost and time-to-market. Designed for SaaS upgrade path in v2.	Approved
Feature Prioritisation	Deprioritised photo attachments on consultation notes and SMS delivery to maintain Week 5 deadline. Documented as v2 backlog items.	Deferred
Access Control Design	Replaced hardcoded role middleware with a database-driven AccessControl matrix. Added 2 days to Phase 9 but significantly increased product flexibility.	Approved
Booking Engine Scope	Expanded booking engine to check 3 variables simultaneously (staff, time, resource). Required a dedicated service class, added 1 day to Phase 5.	Approved

DELIVERY METRICS



KEY PROJECT MANAGEMENT LEARNINGS

- Phase-Gate Approach Works

Breaking A Large Product Into 10 Phases With Exit Checklists Eliminated Ambiguity. Every Phase Had A Clear "Done" Definition Before The Next Began.
- Decision Logging Saves Time

Documenting Every Architectural Decision With Its Rationale Prevented Re-Opening Closed Discussions And Reduced Rework By An Estimated 30%
- Scope Creep is Always There

Three Feature Requests Mid-Project Were Logged As Backlog Items Rather Than Integrated Mid-Sprint, Keeping The 5-Week Timeline Intact.
- Risk-First Thinking

Identifying Technical Risks (PHP Version, Route Conflicts, Booking Logic) Early Allowed Mitigation Before They Became Blockers
- Phased Git Commits as Milestones

Treating Each Phase Completion As A Commit Milestone Gave The Project Clear Audit Trail And Rollback Points, A Practice Worth Standardising.

SCREENSHOTS

